

DAY 12: LOWER YOUR ELECTRIC BILL

Do you ever take electricity for granted? I know I certainly do. It only takes one of our infamous Florida thunderstorms for me to remember just how much I rely on power throughout the day.

But this lifestyle of convenience also brings a greater dependence on more gadgets, more technology, and more outlets to plug everything into...which isn't bad per se, but can result in a pretty hefty electric bill. And if you live in a colder climate during the winter months, you know firsthand the considerable cost difference between January and June!

I honestly thought our electric bill would go down after we moved to Florida, but to my surprise, air conditioning is not cheap. That, and it's kind of necessary. Going without can be downright unbearable during the hot summer months, not to mention the mold and mildew potential from high humidity.

But even though we find ourselves using more electricity as a result of our air conditioner, there are still many other areas besides heating and cooling where we can cut back. There's our refrigerator, washer, dryer, cooking appliances, dishwasher, electronics, and of course, the lamps, ceiling fans, and overhead lights we use every day. When you really stop and think about it, just about everything we own runs on some sort of electricity, so it's no wonder we've become such an energy hungry culture.

While I do agree it's a huge inconvenience to constantly monitor electricity usage, this *is* an area of our budget where we have complete control. Here are six energy saving strategies to implement right away:

1. ADJUST THE TEMPERATURE OF YOUR HOME

Whether you use heat, air conditioning, or both, adjusting your thermostat every time you leave the house or head to bed makes a pretty big difference